

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The Field, Its Scope and Its Exam Significance

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Field, Its Scope and Its Exam Significance

- [1] This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and.

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- [2] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

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- [3] In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.

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- [4] The significance of political theory lies in control of social life, social criticism and reconstruction, clarification of concepts, and encouragement to mutual.

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v

SYNTHESIS -> The Field, Its Scope and Its Exam Significance is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Essential Vocabulary of Political Inquiry

CENTRAL FOCUS

Essential Vocabulary of Political Inquiry

- [1] This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and.

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- [2] Positivists and behaviouralists try to restrict valid knowledge to empirical and logical statements, but Gauba rejects the move to expel evaluative inquiry from.

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- [3] Dante Germino identified revival with the recovery of political philosophy itself – critical inquiry into right political order, distinct both from reductionist.

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- [4] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

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SYNTHESIS -> Essential Vocabulary of Political Inquiry is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The Facts-Logic-Values Argument

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Facts-Logic-Values Argument

- [1] Gauba begins by defining the political as the public sphere of rule-making, authoritative decision and regulation for the whole community (Gauba, PDF pp.15-16).

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- [2] He then defines political theory as systematic knowledge and distinguishes empirical, logical and evaluative statements within that knowledge (Gauba, PDF p.16).

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- [3] Positivists and behaviouralists try to restrict valid knowledge to empirical and logical statements, but Gauba rejects the move to expel evaluative inquiry from.

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v

- [4] Political theory must therefore include both political science and political philosophy: science explains political reality, while philosophy asks what goals and.

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SYNTHESIS -> The Facts-Logic-Values Argument is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Science, Philosophy, Theory and Ideology

CENTRAL FOCUS

Science, Philosophy, Theory and Ideology

- [1] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

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v

- [2] Political theory must therefore include both political science and political philosophy: science explains political reality, while philosophy asks what goals and.

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v

- [3] Political science relies on observation, generalization and explanation; political philosophy seeks justification and concept-clarification (Gauba, PDF pp.18-20).

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- [4] Theory must include both science and philosophy because public policy needs facts and values together (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

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SYNTHESIS -> Science, Philosophy, Theory and Ideology is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Thinkers, Positions and Illustrative Applications

CENTRAL FOCUS

Thinkers, Positions and Illustrative Applications

[1] A question such as "why do riots occur?" belongs to political science when it seeks causal explanation through observation and generalization (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19.

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[2] A question such as "what is a good society?" belongs to political philosophy because it asks about ends, justification and value (Gauba, PDF p.17).

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[3] Clarifying whether "freedom" means non-interference, self-development or something else is part of political philosophy's concept-clarifying role (Gauba, PDF pp.19.

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[4] Gauba warns that vague political language allows demagogues and autocrats to exploit words like liberty, equality and democracy for emotional manipulation or.

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SYNTHESIS -> Thinkers, Positions and Illustrative Applications is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Comparison Matrix and UPSC Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

Comparison Matrix and UPSC Trap Repair

- [1] In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.

|
v

- [2] This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and.

|
v

- [3] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

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v

- [4] Gauba begins by defining the political as the public sphere of rule-making, authoritative decision and regulation for the whole community (Gauba, PDF pp.15-16).

|
v

SYNTHESIS -> Comparison Matrix and UPSC Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Ownership Boundaries and the Revision Spine

CENTRAL FOCUS

Ownership Boundaries and the Revision Spine

[1] Political means the public/common sphere of authoritative collective regulation (Gaub, PDF pp.15-16).

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[2] The chapter's three statement-types are empirical, logical and evaluative (Gaub, PDF p.16).

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[3] Political science relies on observation, generalization and explanation; political philosophy seeks justification and concept-clarification (Gaub, PDF pp.18-20).

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v

[4] Theory must include both science and philosophy because public policy needs facts and values together (Gaub, PDF pp.17-18).

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v

SYNTHESIS -> Ownership Boundaries and the Revision Spine is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Decline and Revival Debate

- [1] Alfred Cobban described a decline of political theory under both capitalist and communist systems in the mid-twentieth century, yet still insisted that politics.

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- [2] David Easton's 1953 complaint held that traditional political theory was speculative, tied to classical texts and the history of ideas, had produced no outstanding.

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- [3] Easton's own 1969 post-behavioural turn makes the distinction explicit from inside the behavioural camp itself: he called on political science to become practically.

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- [4] Leo Strauss argued that a positivist political science modelled on natural science ignored normative questions altogether and flattened qualitative distinctions.

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SYNTHESIS -> The Decline and Revival Debate is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture

CENTRAL FOCUS

Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture

- [1] Premises: (a) the political is the public/common sphere of authoritative rule (Gaub, PDF pp.15-16); (b) knowledge divides into empirical, logical and evaluative.

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- [2] Mechanism: political life generates factual questions ("why do riots occur?") and value questions ("what is a good society?") simultaneously; a theory that excludes.

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- [3] Conclusion: political theory as a whole must integrate both components; its significance lies in control of social life, social criticism/reconstruction.

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- [4] The debate operates on two levels at once: a methodological dispute over what counts as valid evidence (Easton 1953 vs Strauss/Germino), and a civilizational.

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SYNTHESIS -> Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

CENTRAL FOCUS

Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

[1] When an Indian governance debate is framed only in output/efficiency terms (coverage numbers, disbursement speed), the science/explanation vs.

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[2] Similarly, when a policy is defended purely as "the will of an elected majority," the political-philosophy component asks whether that will still respects rights.

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[3] In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.

|

v

[4] The debate operates on two levels at once: a methodological dispute over what counts as valid evidence (Easton 1953 vs Strauss/Germino), and a civilizational.

|

v

SYNTHESIS -> Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

- [1] This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and.

|

v

- [2] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

|

v

- [3] In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.

|

v

- [4] Gauba begins by defining the political as the public sphere of rule-making, authoritative decision and regulation for the whole community (Gauba, PDF pp.15-16).

|

v

SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] A strong answer can therefore use data to explain unemployment, but it still needs a philosophical yardstick to judge whether a given policy is fair, free or humane.

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- [2] One-line answer spine: political theory is the systematic study of political life that explains reality through science and judges goals through philosophy.

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v

- [3] This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and.

|

v

- [4] Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology.

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v

SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.